gsw-eval: Project Plan

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One sentence

We measure what Swiss German costs when you use a large language model, and how much of that cost comes from spelling rather than from dialect.

Status after feedback

- Idea approved. Sina: good idea, well-designed evaluation. Scope: too much for the time.
- TA question: what is the baseline? Answered below.
- Data: SwissDial received from ETH. Stored in the shared Drive folder, never in the repo.

Scope

Item	Decision	Why
Models	Apertus 8B, Llama 3.1 8B, one API model	Swiss vs not Swiss at equal size, plus a frontier reference
Measures	Normalization quality (chrF), spelling robustness (clean vs noised input), token tax (7 tokenizers)	Cheap once the pipeline runs; this is the research content
Baselines	Lower bound: identity, dialect text copied unchanged. Upper bound: Standard German input	Fixed reference points that are not models
Fresh set	30 Standard German sentences, 3 native writers, texting style	Checks that synthetic noise behaves like real spelling. One hour per writer
Human ratings	50 outputs, 2 raters, Cohen's kappa	Validates chrF. On the course learning goals
Public text	Swiss German web text for spelling spread of token cost	Real writers, no references needed, no recruitment
Cut	lm-evaluation-harness, hosted leaderboard, 4 extra models	Infrastructure, not science. Professor listed them as too much

Roles

Who	Code	Report
Erik	Repository, CLAUDE.md, CLI, model adapters (API, Colab), token tax module, results table generator	Method, results
Simone	SwissDial loader and splits, noise generator (rules for real texting spelling, written by her, coded with AI), 30-sentence set, error analysis of 50 outputs	Data, error analysis
Kelvin	Metrics (chrF, bootstrap confidence intervals, kappa), both baselines, unit tests, README, one-command rerun on a fresh machine	Related work, baselines, discussion
All	One Swiss German speaker each for the mini set. Review every pull request by someone else	Final read-through together

Timeline

Dates	Milestone	Gate
Oct 6 to 12	Repo, data loader, identity baseline, token tax table	First result exists
Oct 13 to 19	Pilot: 100 sentences, Apertus and API model, clean and noised. Noise generator v1	Decide the story: quality gap or cost gap
Oct 20 to 26	All three models, full SwissDial, upper bound, confidence intervals. Form sent to writers	Core results
Oct 27 to Nov 2	Fresh set and ratings in, kappa, error analysis, spelling spread on public text	Checkpoint: core done
Nov 3 to 9	Figures, results table, README, tests, rerun verified by a non-author	Repo gradable
Nov 10 to 16	Report. Full draft Nov 13, two rewrite passes	Report readable
Nov 17 to 20	Fixes only. Submit Nov 19	Done

Two checkpoints

- **Oct 19.** If no pilot numbers exist, the fresh set is cut the same day.
- **Nov 2.** Whatever is not done becomes a limitations paragraph. The report is written on what exists.

If time is left after Nov 2, in this order: deeper error analysis with examples per dialect, then a small fine-tuned ByT5 baseline. Never a fourth model.

Working rules

1. AI coding agents for all code. Each person runs them on their own modules only.
2. Every change is a pull request, read by one other person before merge.
3. Type hints, unit tests, virtual environment, one command to rerun everything. These are graded.
4. Data stays out of the repo. SwissDial lives in the shared Drive folder; the loader reads from a local path.
5. The report states that AI assistants were used for code. All sources must be cited.
6. Weekly 30-minute call, same slot. Kanban board updated before the call.

Week one tasks

Erik	Repo with README, CLAUDE.md, pyproject, .gitignore. Kanban with these tasks. Shared Drive folder. Overleaf project from the final report template.
Simone	Share SwissDial files. Write 10 to 15 texting-spelling rules in plain words (for example ä to ae, dropped final letters, common short forms).
Kelvin	Metric functions (chrF, bootstrap intervals) and the identity baseline as the first module, with tests.

Definition of done

A fresh machine can run one command and reproduce every number in the report. The report answers one question with four figures. Every claim has a number with an interval behind it.